

Mechanics WS 5

(Take $g = 9.8 \text{ m} \cdot \text{s}^{-2}$, for the following Q1-4)

- An object of mass m is thrown vertically upwards in a medium with a resistance $R = \frac{mv}{k}$, where v is the velocity of the object and k is a constant. Given $t = 0 = x$ and the initial velocity is $k(c - g)$, where c is a constant and g is the acceleration due to gravity, x is the distance travelled in time t .
 - Draw a neat sketch of the motion and the forces acting at a point P , distance x from the origin. Hence write down the equation of the motion.
 - Find the time taken by the object to reach the highest point H and find the height of H above the point of projection.
 - The object falls to its original position with the same law of resistance. Will the time of descent be the same as that of ascent? Give your reasons.
- Find the tangential speed of the earth at the equator due to its rotation about its axis, given that the radius of the equatorial circle is 6440 km . [Use exercise 4(a)]
- A ball of mass 3 kg is thrown vertically upwards from the origin with an initial speed of 6 ms^{-1} . The ball is subject to a downward gravitational force of 18 newtons and air resistance of $\frac{v^2}{2}$ newtons in the opposite direction to the velocity, v metres per second
 - Show that until the ball reaches its highest point, the equation of motion is $\ddot{y} = -\frac{1}{6}(v^2 + 36)$ where y metres is its height
 - Show that while the ball is rising $v^2 = 36 \left(2e^{-\frac{y}{3}} - 1 \right)$
 - Show that the ball's maximum height is $3 \ln 2$ metres
 - Show that the ball's speed on its return to the origin is $3\sqrt{2}$ metres per second
- Two stones are thrown simultaneously from the same point in the same direction and with the same non-zero angle of projection (upward inclination to the horizontal), α , but with

different velocities V_1 and V_2 metres per second where $V_1 < V_2$.

The slower stone hits the ground at a point P on the same level as the point of projection. At that instant the faster stone just clears a wall of height h metres above the level of projection and its (downward) path makes an angle β with the horizontal.

- Show that, while both stones are in flight, the line joining them has an inclination to the horizontal which is independent of time
- Hence, express the horizontal distance from P to the foot of the wall in terms of h and α .
- Show that $V_2 (\tan \alpha + \tan \beta) = 2V_1 \tan \alpha$ and deduce that, if $\beta = \frac{1}{2}\alpha$, then

$$V_1 < \frac{3}{4} V_2$$

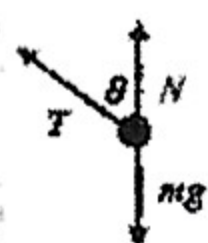
- A particle moves along a straight line so that its displacement, x metres, from a fixed point O is given by $x = 1 - 3 \cos\left(\frac{t}{2}\right)$, where t is measured in seconds.
 - Sketch the graph of x as a function of t for $0 \leq t \leq 4\pi$
 - Hence, or otherwise, find when and where the particle first comes to rest after $t = 0$.
 - Find a time when the particle reaches its maximum speed. What is this speed?
- In a certain harbour at 6am it is low tide and at 12:30pm it is high tide. Low tide is at 4.5 metres and high tide is 10.6 metres. Assume that the motion of the tide can be approximated by SHM.
 - Write down an equation to represent the depth of water at time, t .
 - If a ship requires a minimum depth of 8 metres, when can it first enter the harbour after 6am?
- The depth x metres of the water in a certain South Coast harbour is found to vary approximately according to the equation $\ddot{x} = -\frac{x}{4}$. Given that t is the time in hours and it is known that the difference between high and low tide is 4 metres,

- a. Prove that the time between successive high tides is 12.6 hours, correct to the nearest $\frac{1}{10}$ of an hour.
 - b. Find the rise in the water level during the first hour after low tide. Give your answer in metres, correct to two decimal places.
 - c. Find the rate at which the level is falling two hours after high tide. Give your answer in metres per hour, correct to two decimal places.
8. The velocity v m/s of a particle moving in simple harmonic motion along the x -axis is given by $v^2 = -5 + 6x - x^2$, where x is in metres.
- a. Between which two points is the particle oscillating?
 - b. Find the centre of motion of the particle.
 - c. Find the maximum speed of the particle.
 - d. Find the acceleration of the particle in terms of x .
9. A particle P moves along the x -axis so that at time t seconds it is x cm from the origin O and its velocity is v cm/s. Initially the particle is at rest at the origin.
- a. If the acceleration of P is given by $\ddot{x} = 4(40 - x)$ cm/s², use $\ddot{x} = \frac{d}{dx}(\frac{1}{2}v^2)$ to show that $v^2 = 4(80x - x^2)$
- b. Prove that P moves in the interval $0 \leq x \leq 80$.
 - c. Find the maximum velocity of the particle, and where the maximum occurs.
10. A particle is moving in simple harmonic motion about the origin
- a. Assuming that $\ddot{x} = -n^2x$, show that $v^2 = n^2(a^2 - x^2)$, where a is the amplitude
 - b. When the particle is 3 metres from the origin, its speed is 8 m/s, and when it is 4 metres from the origin its speed is 6 m/s. Find the period and amplitude of the motion.
 - c. Find the greatest acceleration of the particle
11. A particle is moving in a straight line. At time t seconds it has displacement x metres from a fixed point O on the line. Its velocity v m/s is given by $v = -\frac{1}{8}x^3$. The particle is initially 2 metres to the right of O .
- a. Show that the acceleration a , is given by:
$$a = \frac{3}{64}x^5$$
 - b. Find an expression for x in terms of t
 - c. Describe the limiting motion of the particle

Answers:

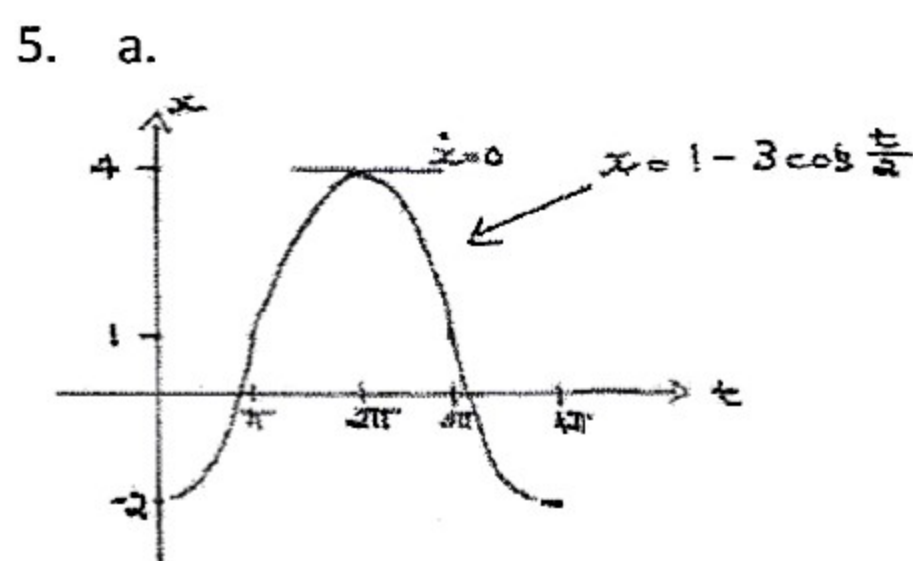
1. (a) $m \frac{dv}{dt} = -mg - \frac{mv}{k}$ (b) $t = k \log_e(c/g)$, $h = k^2(c - g) + gk^2 \log_e(g/c)$ (c) The time of descent < the time of ascent, since the gravity opposes the upward motion of the object.

2. 468 m/s (1690 km/h)



3. (a) (e) the particle would lift off the table and behave like a regular conical pendulum

4.



- b. $\dot{x} = 0$, $t = 2\pi$ s when $x = 4$ m; $t = \pi$ s, max speed = $\frac{3}{2}$ m/s

6. a. $x = 7.55 - 3.05 \cos(\frac{2\pi}{13}t)$; b. 9:33 am

7. b. 0.24 m; c. 0.84 m/h

8. a. $1 \leq x \leq 5$; b. 3 m; c. 2 m/s; d. $3 - x$ m/s²

9. c. 80 m/s when $x = 40$

10. b. $A = 5$, $T = \pi^2$; c.

max acceleration = 20 ms^{-2}

11. b. $x = \frac{2}{\sqrt{t+1}}$; c. As $t \rightarrow 0$, $x \rightarrow 0$, $v \rightarrow 0 \text{ ms}^{-1}$